after the Soviet army exited Afghanistan.[8] Millions of Pathans sharing wild frontier regions between Pakistan and Afghanistan once again became the recipients of guns and bombs that would soon be turned against the troops of the nations that supplied them. As Musharraf himself put it in his memoir: "I believe that our greatest oversight was to forget that when you help to organize and use people fired by extraordinary religious or ideological zeal to achieve your objectives, you must consider that they might be using you to achieve their objectives."[9] More Muslim terrorists now live in Pakistan than in any other nation, despite repeated vows to arrest or expel all of them, and in spite of several major army attacks aimed at eliminating extremist fundamentalist madrassas like the Red School in Islamabad, where thousands of young jihadis were trained.

On 13 December 2001, a car full of armed Pakistanis crashed through a gate of the Lok Sabha (House of the People) in New Delhi, where 500 of India's elected leaders, including Prime Minister Vajpayee and his entire cabinet, sat assembled. Indian police managed to kill those Pakistani terrorists before any of them could enter the heart of India's democratic parliament, though nine guards died in the exchange of fire. For the next six months, however, India's huge army, on red alert, moved closer to the Line of Control in Kashmir, as did Pakistan's smaller force. The two nuclear powers thus faced each other eyeball to eyeball till mid-June 2002, posing the greatest prolonged potential danger to South Asia as a whole, and to world peace, since the Kargil war.

General Powell immediately flew to India to appeal to Vajpayee and his cabinet to exercise greater restraint in its response, but it was only after June 2002, when the State Department pronounced India "too dangerous" for American tourists, and after General Electric and several other multinationals with heavy investments in India withdrew their office staffs and capital from New Delhi for fear of possible nuclear war, that India decided to pull back its troops. Billions of dollars in corporate investments had helped to spark India's recent economic miracle of rapid development as it vigorously embraced global enterprise, and India was sensitive to foreign fears now endangering not only its tourist industry but also future growth. Pakistan quickly followed India's pullback of forces from the Line of Control, defusing the worst crisis of the new millennium.

Yet Pakistan itself continued to fall deeper into a state of fundamentalist violence. In February 2002, Daniel Pearl, a young *Wall*